

December

9



1940

Infantry tanks

During World War II, the North African campaign of the Allied forces opened with shots fired by British infantry tanks called Matilda II. Although slow-moving, these tanks were heavily armoured, protecting the infantry.

Born this day

1934 Judi Dench, British actor. She started out as a theatre actor in 1957 and went on to star in a wide range of films. She is well known for playing the character M in the *James Bond* film series.



1824 Battle of Ayacucho

During Peru's War of Independence, military general Antonio José de Sucre led an army of rebels to victory against Spanish forces, effectively ending Spanish rule in the country.



1955

Euro flag

The flag of Europe was adopted by the Council of Europe. It features a dark blue background with a circle of 12 golden stars at the centre, symbolizing the union of the European nations.

Also on this day

1979 The World Health Organization (WHO) declared the eradication of the deadly smallpox virus.

1992 During the Somalian Civil War, the UN launched an international mission called Operation Restore Hope to rescue Somalian civilians from hunger and violence.